

Jesus Is Our Head and Provider

Please open to Ephesians 5.

Hallelujah.

For you who understand how the teaching anointing works, there will be revelations that God has stored in your spirit. When that gift activates itself, it will go get one of those revelations and bring it to the forefront. That will be the one He is going to anoint you to teach.

It is quite futile to try to teach something else. He will leave that one at the forefront of your spirit, and then He goes and gets your mind. He employs your mind as a vehicle to pull that revelation out, line upon line, precept upon precept.

Many times when He was training me about the flow of the teaching gift, in the days when I did not know the teaching gift has two anointings, I missed that. One anointing is to pull the revelation out. The other is continually discerning the crowd and feeding back to the teacher. If a person teaches beyond what the crowd is understanding, then that gift will stop you, relocate you, and then you begin to flow again.

I did not really understand how that gift operated until God was able to take me into the Spirit and show me a few more things.

In the past, at times I would look at the obvious need and think I needed to teach one thing or another. The whole time, the Holy Spirit would already have pulled a revelation to the forefront of my spirit. To try to bypass that one and pull anything else out is absolutely futile.

How many know there is an acceptable will for a service, but then there is a perfect will? Jesus not only wants us to follow Him in our daily lives; He wants us to follow Him through a service, in business decisions, and wherever He goes.

Amen.

There has been one thing at the forefront of my spirit that I have not been able to get very far away from, and that is Jesus as Provider.

I could stand here and tell you in tears right now, concerning the body of Christ, that if there is one position He wants you to know Him in, it is this wonderful position He has provided for you as your Provider.

He brought this to full revelation in my spirit, that little piece of the puzzle I had been lacking, that little mystery He wanted to add to it that I was failing to understand. I understood it for teaching's sake and was even able to teach much of it because I knew it was fact according to what God was saying in His Word, but I did not know it by transformation.

Now I am starting to know it by transformation.

I told Tim when that revelation came to me, "My God, Tim, it has transformed me already. We are at the end of one era and beginning another era. Some of the problems, some of the fights we have been having in the ministry, are over. It is over. It is just a matter of manifestation, which is on its way right now."

It is over.

To understand Him in that position as Provider, and I mean Provider, there is no legalism in it. There is no law in it. Even tithing and giving is an instruction of grace.

We have wondered, "It was a commandment under the law. Do we carry the law into the New Testament, into our covenant? Are we really supposed to tithe?"

So many of us, trying to understand it, decided, "No, tithing and giving is not really under the New Testament." So we put a little box in the back of the church. "It is your free will. We will just teach what He said about how He will bless giving, and you just do as God moves you in the little box."

That is okay. People can do what they want. I do not care. But I can tell you this much: tithing and giving is an instruction of grace.

If tithing was law, you would qualify by legalistically dropping your tithe and offering in a bucket. Many of us have tithed and given since Noah's ark. You have your name scribed in the original board when they put the planks up: "I gave the first hundred to Noah to build the ark."

But you say, "I have tithed and given for four thousand years, and I cannot tell any difference between my covenant and the sinner's, because when they go down, I go down with them."

If tithing and giving were legalistic, then the meritorious fact that you dropped a tithe check in the offering would be enough. But legalism is not in our covenant. Grace is in our covenant. Tithing and giving is an instruction of grace.

That is why some of us violate grace by violating our relationship with Jesus Christ. The door of blessing shuts, and we do not know why because we are still tithing and giving.

In the position of Provider, I found out there is a relationship and fellowship with Jesus involved in this thing.

I told you I would have church.

One of the problems I had understanding this was that in Ephesians 5, the example He used was a covenant between a man and a woman. In this covenant between a man and a woman, He used that to illustrate a great mystery concerning Christ and the church.

With a divorce rate in the nation at something like fifty-three percent, I am afraid that kind of relationship remains a mystery.

Nevertheless, it still has to do with Jesus as our Provider. Now that I am understanding that mystery, never have I been shaken with so much confidence that my God has supplied my need, will supply it, and has continued to supply it.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

This makes me want to dig in and find out all I can find out about it.

I did not understand. My mother died of alcoholism, cirrhosis of the liver, when I was twenty-seven years old. My dad died in Muskogee in the Veterans Hospital. He also died of alcoholism. His body shut down because of it.

I was here preaching. He was dying one hour away from me, and I did not even know him. He left us when I was three years old. He came back one time when he got out of prison, when I was a freshman in high school, and I did not know who he was sitting in the kitchen.

My mother was disappearing all the time, God bless her heart. She would be gone for several months at a time when we lived with Grandpa. My sister is here in the crowd. She knows how it was.

Grandpa, I think, saw a lot of my old man in me. Sister Chris found all my relatives. She tracked them down for me. I got to talk to my dad's sisters and found out some things about him.

I think Grandpa got upset because of the way my dad treated my mother, and I think he took some of that out on me. He even admitted at the end that he treated me awful bad.

When I first got born again, it was in a holiness, ultra-holiness Pentecostal church. They taught me God was doing a lot of things to me that He was not doing: taking my money, sending sickness and disease, sending catastrophes so it would get me down to a state where I would be humbled enough to change, because I did not know what was good for me.

"It is better to make heaven and have God do these things to you than not to make heaven."

So I got born again, and they told me my heavenly Father was much like my grandpa and my earthly father: beats you and abandons you, beats you and abandons you.

Then somebody handed me a tape by Kenneth Hagin. I found out I was the righteousness of God in Christ by birth of the Holy Spirit. When I have a problem, buddy, I have a Father. Do not run from Him. Run to Him.

It changed my life.

Hallelujah.

Oh, my God, did I get to know Him. Did I get to know Jesus as my Father.

For twenty-two years I preached the Word. I preached confession. I preached praying in the Holy Ghost. I preached mortification. I am a veteran of many of those things.

Now listen to me closely. If I preached all these things those many years and now had a mystery unfold to me that brings Jesus into my life as Provider in a position I have never let Him hold before, do you not think you ought to listen?

Hallelujah.

How many times have you gone through this, Brother Roberson? Probably six times I have read my own letter.

I said, "God, I have to read it again."

I got up and preached at Bill Bosansky's camp meeting. Do you think I could stick with all the subject matter? I could not. I had to get my letter out and read it again. I had to fight myself from reading it the next night again. Why? Because it is ministering to me so much that I am attaining a new position of enforcement, of grace, of something Jesus has wanted to be in full necessity that I have never had the privilege of experiencing before.

I know what He wanted to teach this morning. How can I do anything but follow Him?

My times of worship, as your times of worship can be if they are not already, get to craving. I do not mean I am hungry anymore. A hungry man desires to be fed, but a craving man wants pie. He wants the pudding and the cream. He wants his pie, and he wants to eat it too.

When Tim and I went to see Holy Hubert, on the way back on the airplane I thought, "Is it because the airplane is going up? Is that why my hands are so free of the emotional lead and the weights that so easily beset?"

That emotional lead holds your hands down. The devil is indicting: "God, he is unfaithful. He is unfaithful. You are going to fail. You are stupid. You are nobody. You are hopeless. Nobody likes you."

He keeps badgering and hammering until you can hardly lift those hands because of the emotional lead holding them down. What you are fighting to raise your hands is not just emotion. You are fighting those circumstances that are keeping you down.

On the airplane, it felt like I had helium in my hands.

I said, "Tim, I am really having trouble keeping my hands down. I am craving worship. I have been on a plane too long. My hands just about floated up."

I just about had a worship service right on the airplane. I knew the stewardess would stop and think I was weird.

This mystery is causing me to understand Jesus in the position He has provided for me, a position that eluded me for twenty-two years because I did not understand the example He was giving: husband and wife; Christ and the church.

Ephesians 5. Jesus talks in verse 19 about ministering to your own spirit:

Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;
Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ;
Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.

Then He says:

Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord.
For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the church: and He is the saviour of the body.

Look at verse 23 closely. Another word for head there is covering. He said, wives, submit yourselves to the covering of your husband, even as Christ is the covering of the church, the Head, and the Savior of the body.

When I first started picking this up in my spirit, I noticed these were two statements. I said, "Why did He call Jesus not only the Head of the church, but the Savior of the body?"

If He was the Head of the church, you know He would already be the Savior of the body. Why would He make a distinction between these two things?

The reason He made the distinction is that not only is Christ the Head, or covering, for the church, but He is also the Savior, or Provider, of the body.

He came and took His bride out of the world and provided salvation for her. He took her out of disease and provided healing for her. He took her out of torment and provided peace for her. He took her out from under the dominion of Satan, her enemy, and gave her power over all of his power so he could not hurt her, the church.

He is not only the covering, but also the Provider of the body of Christ.

Once I can understand my position in divine order as the covering of my family, then I will begin to understand how much Jesus wants to provide for me those things He has provided for me. Not only is He my covering, but He is the Provider of all my needs.

If you can understand this by the Spirit, your spirit is going to reach up and get hold of it, and it will tear literal hell out of the bottom of your lack. Newfound words will come to the forefront of your spirit and establish you on the most powerful foundation you ever dreamed possible.

But in my relationship with Jesus, I must take it further than that. I must take it into fellowship.

The easiest way to describe the difference between these two conditions with God is this: relationship means two relatives in the same ship. I am breaking it down to third-grade level. Relationship is two relatives in the same ship, put into the same ship by the same gene pool.

Fellowship is two fellows who have been put in the same ship because they want to be in the ship with each other.

When I was born again, I entered into a relationship with my Father. But He does not want me to remain a distant relative. He does not want to wait until my feet touch the shores of heaven to get to know me. He wants me to enter into fellowship on this side of glory, not remain a distant relative.

To understand Him in this position as Provider, my friend, it not only takes relationship; it takes fellowship. I am talking about the kind of fellowship you find in a marriage where the man and woman, husband and wife, are deeply committed to each other, and betrayal is a foreign word.

How many desire to know Jesus in that kind of fellowship?

Hang on.

For you old-timers, I have shaved ten pages for you.

Hallelujah.

First of all, for the man, we are going to make an analogy between the husband as the covering of the home and Christ as the covering and Provider of the church.

The man has the privilege of being the priest of his home. The first order of priesthood is not only to provide a covering of love that his wife can submit to, but also to provide a covering for her of all the things she has need of, to meet her needs in the natural.

What Paul was talking about in verse 23 is that Christ is not only the Head, or covering, of the church, but He is also the Savior, or Provider, of the body. Under Christ's covering as the Head of the church, He has provided for every need the church could possibly have, because Savior also means Provider.

He has provided for her peace and security. He has promised to meet all her needs according to His riches in glory. He has provided for her well-being by destroying the hold of sickness and disease over her. He has also taken the only enemy she had and given her power over all of his power so he could not hurt her.

Jesus is truly the Savior of the body. He loves His church more than a man could love his wife when marriage is everything it should be.

He loves the church so much that when He said, "Husbands, love your wives as your own bodies," He was saying that the church has become one with Him. We are members of His body, of His flesh, and of His bones.

Not to meet our needs would be not to meet His own needs. Not to love us would be not to love Himself. Not to nourish and cherish us would be to deny Himself what He desires most: an intimate relationship and fellowship with us.

Paul used the covenant between a husband and wife, and the covering he is supposed to provide for his wife as head of the home, to help you understand how much Jesus wants to fellowship with you, and how much it delights Him when you feel the intimacy and security of His covering.

He wants you to feel free to bring all your needs to Him, and to know that nothing you need, no matter how great or small, is ever any bother to Him. Like a husband with his wife, He is just as delighted in your fellowship with Him because as your covering, He is also your Provider.

It is not how big or small the thing is that you are asking. It is the fact that you are coming to Him and fellowshiping with Him as a wife would with her husband over your needs.

When a husband fulfills his commitment to his wife, covers her, and provides for her needs, and she comes to him with a list of things she needs, it was not the needs that brought them together in the first place. It was when they fell in love and decided to spend their lives together.

The needs were present anyway, but the husband did not mind because it was her he wanted to be with. So meeting her needs became a wonderful time of fellowship. She did not mind because being under his covering meant spending lots of time with him. When she met him at the door, it was not to see what was in his hands, but to be with him.

This is a great mystery, but I speak concerning Christ and you.

This is why Paul said what he did about divine order in the Corinthian church. If a person does not understand the relationship between husband and wife, it is hard for that person to understand their own relationship with Christ as Head of the church and Provider.

The whole reason God set divine order into the church was so a man could understand how to submit himself to Christ. Once he understands, as head of the family, that the whole priesthood is to love his wife and cover her by providing for her and the family's every need, then he can understand how much it means to Jesus as Head of the church to cover him, supply his needs, and provide for all the needs of the family.

This is why Paul was so strong when teaching divine order in 1 Corinthians 11, using words like dishonors to show how God really feels about us taking our place in divine order and about the husband being able to meet the wife's needs.

The man who loves his wife would no more dream of not meeting her needs than Christ would dream of not meeting the needs of the church.

God, I want to know Him like that.

One of the big problems in the body of Christ is that we do not know this. Most of us are unaware that one of the greatest provisions Jesus has made for the church is that while we are under His covering, as the husband is to the wife, He is our Provider.

Sometimes when we go to Jesus, instead of simply presenting Him with a need and then entering into a time of fellowship with Him for being a good Provider and meeting that need, we project Him as a bad husband. We spend our time trying to get Him to do something instead of honoring Him as our Provider and worshiping Him as someone who already has.

Did He not say:

What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them?

When a husband is a good provider in the relationship he has with his wife, she never has to come to him and beg for her needs and the needs of the family. She has all the confidence in the world that her husband will meet her needs because she knows him and loves him, and he knows her and loves her.

They spend time fellowshiping together.

In the position Jesus has given to us, He is trying to get you to learn how to submit to Him as your Provider. To do that, somewhere along the way we are going to have to get to know Him.

Perfect love casts out fear. He that has fear has torment. Why would I be afraid? I am afraid of the present. I am afraid of the future. Why do I have torment? Because I have no confidence. Why? Because I do not know Him.

There is no use telling you to get to know Him, telling you there is a place where you can know Him as Provider, without at least giving you the first step to get into it.

Where the wife comes to love, honor, and respect her husband, she does not worship him. Their relationship with each other is in the soul realm. In this earth, there is nothing stronger than a soul tie. We love, honor, and cherish each other, but we do not worship each other. That belongs to God.

God demonstrated this in the Garden of Eden when He said, "It is not good for man to be alone." Adam was in perfect fellowship with God. How could God call him alone? It was not Adam's spirit God was calling alone. It was his soul.

So God created a woman to establish a soul tie with, so neither one of them had to be alone again. As human beings we operate toward each other on the level of the soul. But as spiritual beings we operate toward God on the level of our spirit. The highest level of fellowship is to get to know Jesus through worship.

Hallelujah.

I am not talking about worshiping with other believers in a public assembly. Thank God for public worship services in our own churches. But what I am talking about is private worship.

You know as well as I do that you cannot get enough in a public assembly. How long do you want to stay? We have to get two or three good worship songs out, then go on over to the rest of it and get you out in time. How much are you going to get in two or three services like that a week? We cannot get enough to combat the twenty-two hours a day you have to give to the world.

I am talking about private worship, when you are alone in the inner sanctuary of your own heart, just you and God. It may be your car, a room, somewhere in the house, a place where you can be alone together.

I can promise you, if you could only understand the results this is going to produce before you actually went into your private closet to worship God and saw the results with your own eyes, then you would make an appointment with God for a time of worship.

Whether you were a businessman, preacher, or housewife, it would not matter. Like any business appointment you esteem most important, this one would rank at the top for results.

You have no idea what thirty minutes to an hour of pure worship would do to a person's relationship with God.

First of all, there is a spirit of lack that controls the level of blessing in many believers' lives simply because they do not know how this spirit operates.

He operates by getting you to close the windows of heaven, as far as your personal blessings are concerned, by getting you to chime in with him over God not meeting your needs.

The spirit of lack is a professional and knows how to come in at the right time and begin to scream about the hopeless state of your circumstances.

"Where is God?" he will scream. "Where is He?"

Even though you cannot hear him with your physical ear because he is a spirit, you can hear him with your inner ear. The way his voice comes across is by screaming at you and setting up a series of emotions that can be so strong that a person not knowing the source will sometimes shudder under the weight of them.

Anybody ever been visited?

This spirit is highly successful in getting believers to cooperate with him against God. When they do, he begins to shut their supply lines down.

This is why Jesus was so positive in His instructions in Matthew 6:

Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink;
nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on.
Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?

Jesus was even more explicit in verse 34 when He said:

Take therefore no thought for the morrow...

The reason Jesus said, "Take no thought saying, What shall we eat? What shall we drink? Wherewithal shall we be clothed?" is because usually thoughts like these have a supernatural origin. Jesus would never have said not to take these kinds of thoughts if they did not have the power to hinder your relationship with Him.

Generally, to turn a whole area in our life where we have been fellowshiping with lack cannot be done in our own strength. This is why we need so desperately to make an appointment with God and learn how to worship Him.

He will teach you. Oh, He will teach you.

You will find that at times it will take all the faith you have to lift your hands in worship and keep your appointment with God. Sometimes in fighting the good fight of faith, it feels like tons of emotional lead is on each hand.

But remember, what you are really fighting is what is keeping wonderful change from coming into your circumstances.

I can tell you from experience that to prosper and come out of your circumstances, you need to become thankful right where you are for what you have and for what God has already done.

This is why Paul said to Timothy:

But godliness with contentment is great gain.

For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out.

And having food and raiment let us be therewith content.

This is the level where we begin to rebuild, by being thankful right where we find ourselves at this moment, to become part of a thankful and holy generation.

What have I been reduced to? What do I have right now? What do I want to build myself out of and into?

He says godliness with contentment is great gain. You brought nothing into this world, and you are going to carry nothing out. Wherever I find myself right now, that is where I have to start.

If I owe everybody in the world, have one can of beans in the cupboard, a broken-down car, and everybody is hauling me around, I am going to start worshiping God for the can of beans in the cupboard, for the people hauling me around, and because I am coming out of debt.

I am going to strive for contentment as the great gain until Jesus is able to walk past the devil and the circumstances, begin to fellowship with me, take me by the hand, and lead me back out as my Provider.

This is the great mystery of the church.

Hallelujah.

Folks, I wrote it down just the way He gave it to me.

In my private closet of worship, I first enter into His presence by worshiping Him and praising Him for saving me. Every time I have done that, He jumps in my spirit.

I say, "I want to praise You and worship You, as You said, because my name is written in heaven. I want to worship You. I want to praise You and glorify You."

I go on like that for a few minutes. I can feel it building.

"I worship and thank You and glorify You that my name is written in heaven, and You saved me."

Then here it comes. One wave, and I am a surfer. I stay with the wave. Whatever brings that presence is what I follow. I stay with the wave.

In my private closet of worship, I first enter into His presence by worshiping and praising Him for saving me. I tell Him how much I love Him and give Him my undivided attention while I am worshiping Him.

In other words, my mind is not somewhere else solving yesterday's problems while my lips do Him lip service. All of me is being poured into each statement of adoration.

After maybe twenty minutes of this, I begin to worship Him as my Provider and thank Him for supplying all my needs and for what I have according to His riches in glory.

I say things like, "You are not a man, God, that You can lie. You have exalted Your Word above Your name. Heaven and earth will pass, but Your words abide forever."

Then I will say, speaking hypothetically in your shoes, "Thank You for that raise on my job," or, "Thank You for giving me the perfect job," or, "Thank You for sending business to my business."

I stay in there until God comes, and I fellowship with Him, and He fellowships with me. Eventually, it may take three or four months, but He will come with healing in His wings. He will come with a blessing as your Provider.

But He will come.